



Security Culture 2.0

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Frontispiece

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SECUR-E

Developer Security Self-Assessment

Understanding your security skills, work environment, and security mindset so you and your team can focus improvement efforts where they will have the most impact.

Estimated Completion Time

15–20 minutes

Number of Questions

24 rated + 3 open

What this survey covers:

A	B	C	D	E
About You <i>4 questions - your role and context</i>	Your Security Skills <i>8 statements - what you know and can do</i>	Your Work Environment <i>8 statements - how your team and org support security</i>	Your Security Mindset <i>8 statements - how you think and feel about security</i>	Open Reflection <i>3 short written prompts - your own words</i>

How to complete this survey

This is not a test. There are no right or wrong answers, only your honest experience of what it is currently like to work on security in your role. The results will only be useful if they reflect how things actually are, not how you think they should be.

For each statement in Sections B, C, and D, choose the number that best describes your agreement, from 1 (Strongly Disagree) to 5 (Strongly Agree). Mark your answer by circling the number or checking the box in that column. For the open prompts in Section E, write as much or as little as is useful to you; there is no minimum length.

Completing this individually takes approximately 15-20 minutes. If reviewing results as a team, allow an additional 30-45 minutes for discussion.

Confidentiality and use of results: Your responses should be shared only with those you choose. If completing as part of a team exercise, individual results will be handled according to whatever agreement you have with your facilitator. This survey does not collect personally identifiable information beyond the role and context fields in Section A, which you may leave blank if preferred.

Section A: About You

A few quick questions about your role and context. This helps interpret your results accurately.

All fields in this section are optional. You may leave any field blank. If you are completing this as part of a group assessment, use a pseudonym or identifier of your choice instead of your name.

Your role	e.g., Software Developer, Tech Lead, DevOps Engineer, Architect, Engineering Manager, Security Engineer
Years of professional experience	e.g., Under 2 years / 2–5 years / 6–10 years / 11–20 years / Over 20 years
Team size (direct teammates)	e.g. 1–3 / 4–10 / 11–25 / 26+
Industry sector	e.g., Finance, Healthcare, E-commerce, Gaming, Telecoms, Government, Education, Consulting, Other

Security context in your current organization:

These questions help place your individual responses in their organizational context. Research consistently shows that the security culture around you strongly shapes how security-related behaviors play out in practice.

Organization security maturity	How would you describe your org overall? Choose one: ☐ Security is rarely discussed or enforced ☐ Security is handled mainly by a specialist team ☐ Security is required of developers but not actively supported ☐ Security is actively supported with tools, time, and champions ☐ Security is deeply embedded in our development culture
Do you have a formal security role, a security champion, or a security team in your organization?	☐ Yes, a dedicated security team ☐ Yes, security champions ☐ No ☐ Unsure

Section B: Your Security Skills and Knowledge

How comfortable are you with security tasks? How capable do you feel in your day-to-day work?

Read each statement and select the response that best reflects your current experience, not your aspirational state or what you think is expected. If a statement does not seem relevant to your current role or project type, use your best judgment about the spirit of the question.

Response scale: 1 = Strongly Disagree | 2 = Disagree | 3 = Neither Agree nor Disagree | 4 = Agree | 5 = Strongly Agree

Statement	1 Strongly Disagree	2 Disagree	3 Neither Agree nor Disagree	4 Agree	5 Strongly Agree
1. I can recognize common security vulnerabilities, such as injection flaws or insecure authentication, in code I write or review.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. When a security tool or code review flags a problem in my work, I know how to assess it and take appropriate action.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. I understand how the technical decisions I make during development can affect the security of the software I build.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. Security concepts and best practices feel largely out of reach for my current skill level.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5. I can explain a security risk clearly enough for a non-technical colleague or manager to understand why it matters.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6. I often discover security problems in my work only after someone else has pointed them out to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7. I have a clear sense of which security skills I still need to develop.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
8. Security tools in my workflow are too complex for me to use effectively without significant guidance.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Scoring note for practitioners: Items 4, 6, and 8 are reverse-scored. Subtract the raw rating from 6 before summing this section's total.

Section C: Your Work Environment

How well does your organization, team, and toolset support you in doing security work?

Think about your current team and organization, not a previous employer or an ideal scenario. The statements in this section ask about the environment around you, not your personal skills or attitudes. A low score here reflects your context, not a personal failing.

Response scale: 1 = Strongly Disagree | 2 = Disagree | 3 = Neither Agree nor Disagree | 4 = Agree | 5 = Strongly Agree

Statement	1 Strongly Disagree	2 Disagree	3 Neither Agree nor Disagree	4 Agree	5 Strongly Agree
9. My team treats security discussions as a normal, expected part of how we develop software.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
10. I have access to security tools that fit naturally into my existing development workflow.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
11. There is at least one person in my organization, a security expert, champion, or knowledgeable colleague, I can turn to for security support.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
12. Delivery pressure in my organization regularly pushes security work to the back of the queue.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
13. My organization allocates dedicated time or resources for security-related work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
14. Security tools I use generate so many false alerts that I have largely stopped relying on them.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
15. When someone on my team raises a security concern, it is genuinely taken seriously.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
16. In my workplace, security is generally treated as the responsibility of a specialist team, not individual developers.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Scoring note for practitioners: Items 12, 14, and 16 are reverse-scored. Subtract the raw rating from 6 before summing this section's total.

Section D: Your Security Mindset

How do you think and feel about security? What drives, or limits, your engagement with it?

These statements are about your attitudes and values around security, including your honest feelings about it, not just your professional position. Some statements might describe a feeling you have had but are not proud of; that is fine and expected. Honest answers are the most useful ones.

Response scale: 1 = Strongly Disagree | 2 = Disagree | 3 = Neither Agree nor Disagree | 4 = Agree | 5 = Strongly Agree

Statement	1 Strongly Disagree	2 Disagree	3 Neither Agree nor Disagree	4 Agree	5 Strongly Agree
17. I believe that writing secure code is just as important as writing code that works correctly.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
18. Thinking about security feels like a natural, instinctive part of how I approach development, not a separate task I add afterward.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
19. The security requirements I am expected to follow often feel like unnecessary overhead that slows me down.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
20. I actively look for ways to improve security in my work, even when no one is requiring me to.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
21. I follow security practices mainly because they are required, not because I personally believe in their value.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
22. I feel a personal responsibility to protect the people who use the software I build.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
23. The amount of security effort my work requires seems disproportionate to the actual risk of being attacked.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
24. I keep my security knowledge up to date through self-directed learning, beyond what my organization formally provides.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Scoring note for practitioners: Items 19, 21, and 23 are reverse-scored. Subtract the raw rating from 6 before summing this section's total.

Section E: Open Reflection

Three short written prompts, your own words, your own experience. There are no minimum lengths.

Each prompt below asks you to think about a specific type of situation or experience from your own practice. Write as much or as little as is helpful. These responses will not be scored, but they provide important context for interpreting your rated responses, particularly when your profile shows a mixed or borderline result.

Reflection 1: Security under pressure

Think about a recent situation where security requirements competed with a delivery deadline or a feature demand. What did you do, and, with the benefit of hindsight, do you think you made the right call? What made the decision easy or difficult?

Reflection 2: Going beyond what was required

Describe a time when you took a security action that nobody was asking you to, something you did on your own initiative. What motivated it? If you cannot think of an example like this, what would need to be different in you, your team, or your organization for it to happen?

Reflection 3: The one change that would make the biggest difference

What is the single most important thing your organization or team could change that would make it genuinely easier for you to build more secure software? Try to be as specific as you can, not just 'more training,' but what kind, delivered how, by whom.

Score Summary

Complete this page after finishing all sections.

How to calculate your score for each section:

Step 1: For items marked as reverse-scored (listed in the Scoring note under each section), subtract your raw rating from 6. For example, if you rated item 4 as 2, the scored value is $6 - 2 = 4$.

Step 2: Sum all eight scored values within each section. Each section score will range from 8 (minimum) to 40 (maximum).

Step 3: Enter your three section totals in the table below. A practitioner or the SECUR-E scoring guide (Deliverable 3) will then map these scores to a behavioral profile.

Survey Section	Subscale Name	Your Score
Section B: Your Security Skills	Skills & Knowledge Score (Items 1-8, reverse: 4, 6, 8)	_____
Section C: Your Work Environment	Environment Score (Items 9-16, reverse: 12, 14, 16)	_____
Section D: Your Security Mindset	Mindset Score (Items 17-24, reverse: 19, 21, 23)	_____

What your scores mean (a quick orientation):

Higher scores in each section indicate higher security capability (Section B), a richer security environment (Section C), and stronger intrinsic security motivation (Section D). These three scores together create a profile, not a single number.

A high score on one dimension and a low score on another is a meaningful pattern, not an error. For example, high motivation in a low-opportunity environment describes a very different situation and calls for a very different response than low motivation in a high-opportunity environment.

Your profile is most useful when interpreted alongside Section E (open reflection) and in the context of your Section A answers about your organization. The scoring guide will walk through each pattern in detail.

Thank you for completing this assessment.

Your scores map to a behavioral profile that will be used to identify the kinds of support most likely to help you and your team build more secure software. The results are meant to be a starting point for conversation, not a judgment of your abilities.

Grounded in DASP (Larios-Vargas et al., 2023) and COM-B Model (Michie et al., 2011)